

GDD: The Last Person in Line

1. Overview

Game Name: *The Last Person in Line*

Theme/Prompt: The Last Person in Line

Genre: Absurd social-survival game / choice-based narrative mystery / queue management drama

Player: Single-player

Platform: PC and mobile

Technical Form: 2D visual-novel style with interactive queue movement

View: First-person perspective

Language/Engine: Unity using C#

The Last Person in Line is a choice-based narrative game where the player joins a mysterious line without knowing what everyone is waiting for. The line stretches endlessly through strange locations: a school corridor, government office, wedding buffet, hospital waiting area, temple queue, airport counter, and finally, somewhere that does not seem real.

The player starts as the last person in line. Their goal is not simply to reach the front, but to understand what the line is for, why no one leaves, and what happens to the person at the end.

The main question of the game is:

If no one knows what they are waiting for, why is everyone still standing in line?

2. Experience

The game should feel funny, tense, irritating, mysterious, and weirdly relatable. The player should feel the exact frustration of waiting in a line that refuses to move, surrounded by people who keep insisting that “this is how it works.”

The horror is not monsters. The horror is bureaucracy.

The player is stuck behind strangers who all have different reasons for staying. Some are patient. Some are angry. Some have been there for years. Some forgot what they came for. Some are only standing because everyone else is standing.

The player should constantly wonder:

“Why am I in this line?”

“What is at the front?”

“Why does no one leave?”

“Why does the line keep getting longer?”

“What happens if I cut the line?”

“What happens if I let someone go ahead of me?”

The emotional experience is built around waiting, obedience, fairness, frustration, and social pressure. The line becomes more than a queue. It becomes a system everyone complains about but still protects.

The fun comes from making tiny choices in a ridiculous social system and watching the entire line react like the player has committed a crime.

3. Mechanics

Core Gameplay Loop

The player begins at the very end of a line. They must interact with people ahead of them, people behind them, and authority figures controlling the queue. Each turn, the player chooses whether to wait, ask questions, move forward, help someone, cut the line, leave temporarily, or challenge the system.

Each interaction gives the player choices such as:

Wait Patiently

The player follows the rules and stays in place. This keeps social approval stable but may increase frustration.

Ask the Person Ahead

The player gathers information about the line. This may reveal clues but can annoy others.

Hold the Spot

The player agrees to save someone's place. This increases trust but may delay progress.

Cut Forward

The player attempts to move ahead unfairly. This gives quick progress but increases suspicion and anger.

Let Someone Behind Go Ahead

The player gives up their place to someone else. This may increase kindness but pushes the player further back.

Leave the Line

The player steps out of the queue. This may reduce frustration, but the line may punish them for "breaking order."

Main Mechanic: Position Meter

The Position Meter shows where the player stands in the line.

At first, the player is last. The line appears simple: move forward until you reach the front. But the game slowly reveals that position is not only physical. It is social, moral, and psychological.

The player can move forward by:

- waiting through turns
- trading favours

- collecting tokens
- solving disputes
- making alliances
- using shortcuts
- cutting the line
- exposing false rules

The player can move backward by:

- letting people pass
- being punished
- losing their spot
- being tricked
- refusing to follow strange queue customs
- stepping out at the wrong time

The twist is that reaching the front too quickly may be dangerous because the player may not understand what they are approaching.

Secondary Mechanic: Patience Meter

The Patience Meter shows how much waiting the player can emotionally handle.

Patience decreases when the player:

- waits too long
- gets pushed back
- hears repetitive announcements
- watches others cut the line
- receives unclear instructions
- is told "just five more minutes"

Patience increases when the player:

- gets useful information
- jokes with others
- takes small breaks
- finds meaning in waiting
- sees progress
- helps someone and feels good about it

If Patience becomes too low, the player may snap, leave impulsively, start a fight, or make reckless choices.

Fairness Meter

The Fairness Meter shows how the line views the player's actions.

High fairness means the player is seen as honest, patient, and respectful of the queue.

Low fairness means the player is seen as selfish, suspicious, or disruptive.

The twist is that being too fair can keep the player trapped forever. Being unfair can help them progress, but may turn the entire line against them.

The player has to balance:

Do I respect the line, or do I escape it?

4. Systems

Choice Consequence System

Every choice affects at least one of three values:

Position

How close the player is to the front.

Patience

How emotionally stable the player remains.

Fairness

How others judge the player's behaviour in the line.

This creates tension because the most socially acceptable option may not be the best option for the player.

Interaction System

The game is divided into short queue interactions. Each interaction presents a small social problem.

Examples:

- the person ahead refuses to move
- someone behind keeps pushing
- a stranger asks the player to hold their spot
- a child starts crying because the line is too long
- an old woman says she has been waiting since morning
- someone claims there is a "VIP line"
- a guard says the counter is closed but the line continues moving
- the person at the front returns to the back silently
- a sign says "Last Person in Line Must Report"

Each interaction gives 3=5 choices. The player must decide whether to preserve order, protect themselves, or disrupt the queue.

Realization System

The player collects “realizations” instead of items.

Examples:

Realization 1: Nobody knows what the line is for.

Realization 2: The line moves even when the front is closed.

Realization 3: People defend the line because they have already waited too long.

Realization 4: The last person in line has a role.

Realization 5: The line only exists because everyone agrees to stay in it.

These realizations unlock stronger choices later in the game.

At the beginning, the player may only have weak choices like:

“Okay, I’ll wait.”

“Sorry, I didn’t know.”

“I’ll move back.”

Later, they unlock stronger choices like:

“Who made this line?”

“Why are we still waiting?”

“I’m not losing my life to a queue.”

“The counter is closed. Go home.”

“I refuse to be last.”

Ending System

The ending depends on the balance between Position, Patience, and Fairness.

Ending 1: Still Waiting

The player follows every rule and remains in line. Time passes. The background changes. The player becomes the kind of person who tells newcomers, “This is just how it works.”

Ending 2: The Cutter

The player reaches the front by cheating, pushing, and manipulating others. They get served, but everyone behind them remembers their unfairness.

Ending 3: The Front Was Empty

The player reaches the front and discovers there is no counter, no reward, and no authority. The line was continuing out of habit.

Ending 4: The Last Becomes First

The player accepts the role of the last person and learns that the last person secretly controls where the line ends, begins, and breaks.

Ending 5: Everyone Leaves the Line

The player exposes the absurdity of the queue. One person leaves, then another, then the whole line dissolves. The final screen shows an empty path where the line used to be.

5. Narrative

The story begins with the player joining a line because they are told it is important. They do not know what the line is for. Nobody gives a clear answer.

Some people say:

“It’s for registration.”

“No, I think it’s for approval.”

“I heard there’s food at the front.”

“You’ll find out when you reach.”

“I’ve waited too long to leave now.”

“Don’t ask questions, you’ll slow the line.”

“You’re lucky you’re only last. Some people aren’t even allowed in line.”

As the player progresses, the line passes through increasingly strange places. It begins in a normal setting, like a school office or public counter, then bends through hallways, staircases, banquet halls, empty roads, and impossible rooms.

The people in line become symbols of different relationships with systems:

- the rule-follower
- the impatient cutter
- the person who has forgotten the goal
- the person who profits from the line
- the person too afraid to leave
- the person who keeps sending others to the back
- the person who knows the line is pointless but stays anyway

Eventually, the player discovers that the most important position is not the front.

It is the back.

The last person gives the line its shape. Without a last person, the line cannot continue.

The story is about bureaucracy, waiting, social order, sunk cost, fairness, obedience, and the strange comfort people find in systems that waste their time.

6. Levels

Level 1: Join the Line

The player enters the line and becomes the last person.

Purpose: Introduce the queue, basic choices, Position, Patience, and Fairness.

Level 2: The Line Does Not Move

The player waits through multiple small annoyances. People complain but refuse to leave.

Purpose: Teach the player that waiting increases fairness but drains patience.

Level 3: Queue Politics

The player meets characters who trade places, save spots, create fake rules, and judge others for not waiting “properly.”

Purpose: Introduce social strategy and consequences.

Level 4: The False Front

The player gets close to the front, only to discover the line bends and continues elsewhere.

Purpose: Break the player’s assumption that progress is simple.

Level 5: The Last Person’s Role

The player learns that being last is not a failure. It is a position the system depends on.

Purpose: Introduce the deeper mystery behind the title.

Level 6: Break the Line

The player must decide whether to reach the front, return to the back, cut the line, leave, or convince everyone else to stop waiting.

The game does not ask:

“Can you reach the front?”

It asks:

“Was the line ever worth standing in?”

Purpose: Ending selection based on previous choices.

7. UI / UX

The UI should feel repetitive at first, then increasingly strange.

Main Screen

The screen shows:

- character dialogue
- player choices
- Position Meter
- Patience Meter
- Fairness Meter
- small queue map
- number of people ahead
- number of people behind
- announcement text from the “authority”

The number of people ahead should sometimes behave strangely. For example:

People ahead: 47

then after waiting:

People ahead: 48

This creates the feeling that the system itself may be lying.

Choice UI

Choices should be written like social decisions, not obvious game commands.

Example:

A. “I’ll wait my turn.”

Fair, safe, draining.

B. “Excuse me, what is this line for?”

Curious, slightly disruptive.

C. “Can you hold my spot?”

Useful, risky.

D. “I was here before them.”

Defensive, status-based.

E. Step out of line.

Freeing, dangerous, irreversible depending on timing.

As the game progresses, choices become more self-aware and rebellious.

Feedback Design

When Patience decreases:

- ambient noise becomes louder
- people repeat the same lines
- screen movement becomes slower
- the player's internal monologue becomes irritated
- the queue number flickers

When Fairness drops:

- people stare
- whispers spread backward and forward
- characters block the player
- the line becomes hostile
- authority figures notice the player

When Position improves:

- the front appears closer
- the background becomes brighter
- new characters become available
- the player hears rumours from ahead

When Line Awareness increases:

- signs contradict each other
- the queue map glitches
- the back of the line becomes visible from the front
- the player unlocks system-breaking choices

Player Definition

The player is an unnamed person who joins a line without fully understanding why. They are not physically trapped. Their limitation is social conditioning and uncertainty.

They are afraid of being unfair, being judged, losing their place, or discovering that all the waiting was pointless.

Player Properties

Position: how close the player is to the front

Patience: emotional ability to keep waiting

Fairness: how morally/socially acceptable others think the player is

Line Awareness: understanding of how the queue works

Confidence: unlocks stronger decisions and confrontations

Player Rewards

The player does not collect coins or weapons. Rewards are information-based and strategic.

Rewards include:

1. new dialogue options
2. queue secrets
3. reduced waiting time
4. increased confidence
5. alternate endings
6. allies in the line
7. ability to break or reshape the queue

Winning and Losing

Winning

The player wins by understanding the line and making a conscious decision about their place in it. Winning does not always mean reaching the front.

The best ending is realizing that a system only has power when people continue participating in it.

Losing

The player loses if they wait forever, lose all patience, become obsessed with fairness, or reach the front without understanding what the line really is.

A bad ending should still be meaningful because it shows how people can become trapped inside systems they never questioned.

Why Is This Fun?

The game is fun because it turns one of the most boring experiences ever — standing in line — into a dramatic, absurd, strategic social system.

Players enjoy:

- testing how long they can tolerate unfairness
- choosing whether to wait, cut, help, or leave
- watching the line react to tiny actions
- discovering why the line exists
- unlocking strange endings
- replaying to reach the front differently
- realizing that the back of the line may matter more than the front

The game uses comedy, frustration, mystery, and social tension. It is funny because everyone is acting like queue etiquette is sacred law, but it is meaningful because real systems often survive only because people keep waiting.

My One-Line Pitch

A choice-based social-survival game where the player discovers that the most powerful person in a line may not be the first, but the last.